SkillNavora · Business AI Stack

COMPLETE GUIDE 02 OF 15

Make Automation

A practical guide with steps, examples and a checklist. Read the chapter, then build the example.

AUTOMATION · COMPLETE GUIDE

Make: visual automation with scenarios, routers and filters

Make (formerly Integromat) builds automations as scenarios. Each app is a module on a canvas, bubbles show how many items pass through, and routers split the flow. This guide builds one scenario end to end: a form submission that is saved to Google Sheets, sent to WhatsApp, and logged for follow-up.

1. Make in one page

- **Scenario** = one automation. It starts with a trigger module, then runs modules in order.
- **Bundle** = one item of data passing between modules. The number in a bubble counts bundles.
- **Router** = a split. Each branch has a filter that decides which bundles it receives.
- **Data mapping** = clicking a field in a later module and choosing a value from an earlier one.
- **Operations.** Each module run uses operations; check your plan's monthly limit before scaling.

2. Build your first scenario

1. Create a scenario, choose a trigger: **Webhooks → Custom webhook**. Copy the URL.
2. Send a test request to that URL (a form, or a tool such as curl) with `name`, `phone`, `need`. Click **Redetermine data structure**, so Make learns the fields.
3. Add **Google Sheets → Add a row**. Map the columns to `name`, `phone`, `need`, and a timestamp.
4. Run once. Check the sheet, then switch the scenario on with **Scheduling: Immediately** (webhooks run as they arrive).

3. Worked example: lead routing with a router

Goal: every enquiry is saved; hot leads (ready to start within a month) get an instant WhatsApp reply and an alert; others get a nurture message.

#	Module	Configuration
1	Custom webhook	Receives the form (JSON).
2	Google Sheets: Add a row	Saves every lead first. Save before routing, so no lead is lost.
3	Router	Two branches.
3a	Filter: `start = this month`	Branch A, hot: WhatsApp module (Cloud API) sends a template message; then Slack or email alert to the counsellor.
3b	Fallback (no filter)	Branch B, nurture: Gmail module sends a welcome email with your resources link, after a 1-day delay (Sleep module).

FILTER TIP

Put the most specific filter first. A router sends each bundle down every branch whose filter passes, so overlapping filters send duplicate messages.

4. Add an AI step

Add an **OpenAI** or **Anthropic Claude** module between steps 1 and 2 to read the free-text `need` and return a category. Map the returned category into the router filter. Keep the instruction strict and ask for JSON. Validate the output with a filter (for example, the category must be one of four values) before any message is sent.

5. Error handling

- Right-click a module and add an **error handler**: *Break* stores the failed bundle for retry; *Resume* continues with a default value.
- Use **Ignore** only for optional steps such as an alert.
- Check **History** to see the input and output of every run.

6. Make compared with n8n

	Make	n8n
Style	Visual, very fast to prototype	Node-based, strong for code and self-hosting
Hosting	Cloud	Cloud or your own server
Best for	Business teams building many small flows	Developers, data pipelines, custom logic

7. Checklist

- Every lead is saved before anything else happens.
- Routers have clear, non-overlapping filters.
- Error handlers set for every external app.
- Operations used are within the plan; monitor the usage page.

Check module names and the pricing page for your plan before you build. Both change over time.